

Dwarf

Pliara recognizes dwarves as its very first recorded humanoid inhabitants, and they remain legendary for their physical power and immovable resolve. Standing between four and five feet tall and weighing around one hundred fifty pounds, these stocky folk possess broad frames and natural endurance that help them survive the toughest working conditions. Most dwarves organize themselves into sprawling, tightly knit clans that work together to forge vast underground settlements or build homes on mountain cliffs. Clan loyalty runs extremely deep, meaning that an insult directed at one dwarf is treated as a direct slight against their entire family line. Despite keeping to themselves most of the time, they occasionally enter into business arrangements with outside species, such as trading high quality smithing work to neighboring orcs in exchange for long distance transport.

The physical traits of dwarven folk change drastically across the different corners of Pliara. Hill dwarves are the most widespread group across populated cities, carrying a proud, noble presence as they manage large clans devoted to mining, hunting, or forging. High in the crags live the range dwarves, who stand slightly taller at three and a half feet and sport strikingly curly red or brown facial hair. Tucked away in the wild forests of The Wild Hook are the tiny canopy dwarves, who grow to less than three feet tall and blend into the hollow trunks of Jiila trees. The isolated marsh dwarves present a far darker look, featuring pale blue or sickly green skin, glowing orange eyes, yellowed fingernails, and messy hair filled with swamp debris.

Dwarven society revolves heavily around specialized labor, craft traditions, and honored family roots. Well known to exemplify Dwarven culture is the Ironmolder Clan, a welcoming family lineage that founded the village of New Heights to raise fostered children from various backgrounds. Experienced dwarven artisans often pass down their trade through strict apprenticeships, teaching their students how to handle stonework, masonry, and metalsmithing. While isolated groups like the chaotic marsh dwarves avoid civilization entirely, most dwarven clans remain dedicated to protecting their homes, honoring their leaders, and preserving ancient traditions passed down across centuries.

Racial Traits

Ability Scores. Your Constitution Score increases by 2

Age. Dwarves do not reach adulthood until around age 50, living to around 350 years.

Alignment. Most dwarves are lawful, believing firmly in the benefits of a well-ordered society. They tend toward good as well, with a strong sense of fair play and a belief that everyone deserves to share in the benefits of a just order. Marsh Dwarves tend to be the exception to this rule, leaning more towards a chaotic and evil living

Size. Most Dwarves stand between 4 and 5 feet tall and average about 150 pounds. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 25 feet.

Darkvision. You can see in dim light within 60 feet of you as if it were bright light, and in darkness as if it were dim light. You can't discern color in darkness, only shades of gray.

Dwarven Resilience. You have advantage on saving throws against poison, and you have resistance against poison damage.

Dwarven Combat Training. You have proficiency with the battleaxe, handaxe, light hammer, and warhammer.

Tool Proficiency: You gain proficiency with the artisan's tools of your choice: smith's tools, brewer's supplies, or mason's tools.

Stonecunning. Whenever you make an Intelligence (History) check related to the origin of stonework, you are considered proficient in the History skill and add double your proficiency bonus to the check, instead of your normal proficiency bonus.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Common and Dwarvish. Dwarvish is full of hard consonants and guttural sounds, and those characteristics spill over into whatever other language a dwarf might speak.

Dwarf Sub-Races

Canopy Dwarf

Making their homes within the hollow trunks of the Great Jiila trees, these Dwarves are native only to the wild, untamed forests of The Wild Hook. Very few have seen these Dwarves in person, and many do not believe them to truly exist. These Dwarves are one with nature, and highly peaceful. The Great Jiila trees have naturally hollow trunks, making a perfect living environment for the Canopy Dwarves, who spend much of their time high in the treetops gathering materials, keeping lookout, or hunting. Many have dedicated their lives to protecting and preserving the wonders of The Wild Hook and all of nature's wonders. Canopy Dwarves stand slightly smaller than normal Dwarves, standing around 2.5 to 3 feet tall. If not for their bulky appearance and heavy facial hair, some Canopy Dwarves may even be mistaken for some of the even smaller races of Pliara. Their special connection with nature has granted them unique abilities that are uncommon in other Dwarves.

Ability Scores. Your Dexterity Score increases by 1.

Dwarven Toughness. As sworn protectors of nature, you may cast Speak With Animals once per day. Starting at 5th level, you may also cast Conjure Animals once per day. Your spellcasting ability for these spells is Charisma. You also gain expertise in the Nature skill, if you do not already have it.

Hill Dwarf

The most abundant dwarven folk in major cities, Hill Dwarves build massive, proud clans centered around specific trades. A single leader or a council guides each group, directing every member toward a shared purpose like mining, hunting, or smithing. Honor dictates their daily life, and a slight against one member offends the whole lineage. While they maintain strong ties with other civilized folk, their opinion of their marsh-dwelling cousins is far harsher. Hill Dwarves know full well that Marsh Dwarves generally choose evil or selfish paths, abandoning the lawful structure that keeps dwarven society standing. Because of this, Hill Dwarves view them with deep suspicion and disdain, considering them a dark blight on the dwarven name rather than kin worth protecting.

Their stout frames carry natural resilience, giving them the stamina to work long hours at the forge or stand their ground in conflict. Settling in bustling urban centers has made them more open to outside trade, yet they never lose their traditional edge or discipline. They approach their work with methodical precision, ensuring that anything forged or built by a Hill Dwarf lasts for generations. That unwavering work ethic earns them widespread respect among city leaders, who frequently rely on dwarven craftsmanship to strengthen urban defenses and fuel local economies. Hill Dwarves remain the industrious backbone of any settlement they inhabit, keeping ancient traditions alive while building lasting regional influence.

Ability Scores. Your Wisdom Score increases by 1.

Dwarven Toughness. Your hit point maximum increases by 1, and it increases by 1 every time you gain a level.

Hill Dwarf

Isolated and chaotic, Marsh Dwarves exist with a single-minded hatred for civilization and every city built by civilized hands. Knowing their mountain kin shun them, they avoid the high peaks entirely, lingering in damp, rot-choked swamps. Their skin displays strange hues, varying from pale blueish tints to sickly green shades. Unkempt facial hair hangs down over their short frames, hosting insects and parasites that feed on the mold trapped within the thick mats. Deep orange eyes cut through the gloom of the bog, paired with long, yellowed fingernails that serve as practical tools in the wilderness.

Their burning malice toward organized settlements leaves them isolated, driving them to form uneasy alliances with goblins, orcs, and other outcasts. Rumors of strange powers follow them through the wetlands, inspiring folk tales that make even hardened mountain dwarves uneasy. Because no outside scholar or elder knows the origin of these abilities, a cloud of dread surrounds their lineage. Marsh Dwarves live out their lives far from the order of the clans, fueled by spite and content to see the works of other humanoids crumble into decay.

Heavy Trudging. Years of trudging through thick marshlands has given you more strength in your legs than other Dwarves. Your base movement speed is now 30ft instead of 25ft.

Ghostly Whispers. Marsh Dwarves are able to communicate in unique ways. You learn the message cantrip. Your spellcasting ability is Charisma for this spell.

Dwarf Sub-Races

Range Dwarf

Preferring to make their homes in high mountain ranges, these Dwarves are rarely seen outside of Highpeak. Although other mountain ranges exist in Pliara, Highpeak is the tallest. The continent is large enough that the Range Dwarves can live in their carved out, mountainside homes and caves with little-to-no interaction with the Highpeak Officials or travelers to Highpeak City.

A Range Dwarf is not immediately distinguishable from a Hill Dwarf upon first glance; however, there are some notable differences. A Range Dwarf's facial hair is almost always extremely curly and either a brown or red color. A Range Dwarf also stands just a hair taller than their brethren, averaging around 3.5 feet.

Ability Scores. Years of mountain climbing and shaping have toned your arms and core. Your Strength Score increases by 1 point.

Mountain Climber. You have advantage on Strength (Athletics) skill checks for climbing. You also have advantage on any Wisdom (Survival) checks made when travelling in a mountainous setting, including within mountain caves.